2024 rule – Bonus Action spells
If you cast a spell with a Bonus Action, you can't cast another spell this turn, except a **cantrip with a casting time of 1 action**.
Hunter's Mark (lvl 1, Divination, 90 ft, V, Concentration 1 h) · **Hex** (lvl 1, Enchantment, 90 ft, V, S, M, Concentration 1 h) · **Divine Smite** (lvl 1, Evocation, Self, V, Instantaneous)

Hunter's Mark (Ranger): you designate a visible creature within range. Each time you hit it with an attack, it takes an extra **1d6 Force damage**. You have Advantage on Wisdom (Perception or Survival) checks to find it. If it drops to 0 HP, a Bonus Action marks a new creature.

Hex (Warlock): you curse a visible creature within range. Each time you hit it with an attack, it takes an extra **1d6 Necrotic damage**. You choose an ability: the target has Disadvantage on checks with it. If it drops to 0 HP, a Bonus Action curses a new creature.

Divine Smite (Paladin): Bonus Action, immediately after hitting a creature with a Melee weapon or an Unarmed Strike. The target takes an extra **2d8 Radiant damage**, plus 1d8 if it's a Fiend or Undead. **Higher-level slot**: +1d8 per slot level above 1.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. A Bonus Action spell blocks other spells that turn, except an action cantrip.
2. Hunter's Mark and Hex require Concentration.
3. Divine Smite is Instantaneous: no Concentration.
4. Each Bonus Action spell uses a level 1 or higher slot.

⚠ Change from 2014

In 2014, the rule already limited you to one Bonus Action spell and an action cantrip; in 2024, it is worded more clearly.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text doesn't say if a Bonus Action spell can be cast *before* the action spell or after. Fix: in 2024, a Bonus Action spell blocks any other spell except an action cantrip, in any order.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe a glowing mark appearing on the prey, a malevolent whisper, a golden flash striking after the blow.

Step 1 – Count the spells:

For this turn: one Bonus Action spell AND at most one action cantrip (or the reverse).

Step 2 – Mark / Hex:

Bonus Action, Concentration. Extra damage on each successful attack against the target.

Step 3 – Change target:

If the target drops to 0 HP, a Bonus Action marks or curses a new one.

Step 4 – Divine Smite:

After hitting in melee, Bonus Action: extra 2d8 Radiant (1d8 more against a Fiend or Undead).

Example: Rafa (Ranger) casts Hunter's Mark (Bonus Action) then attacks with his bow (Attack action): legal. He can't cast Fireball this turn (an action spell).

⚠ Common questions:

Can I cast two Bonus Action spells?

No: one Bonus Action spell per turn.

Can I cast an action cantrip?

Yes, it's the only exception.

Can I attack?

Yes: attacking isn't casting a spell.

Does Hunter's Mark need Concentration?

Yes.

When do I cast Divine Smite?

Immediately after hitting with a Melee weapon or Unarmed Strike.

Does a Fiend take more?

Yes: an extra 1d8 Radiant.

Can I move the mark?

Yes, with a Bonus Action when the target drops to 0 HP.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Order of spells

The text forbids other spells that turn, except an action cantrip. **Option**: apply the text literally.

Multiple attacks

Hunter's Mark adds damage on each hit. **Option**: keep it.

Divine Smite and critical hits

A Critical Hit doubles damage dice. **Option**: Smite's dice are doubled too.

Concentration

Mark / Hex require Concentration: they end if you cast another Concentration spell. **Option**: keep it.

Changing target

The spell needs a Bonus Action to move the mark. **Option**: keep it.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

No swapping Action and Bonus Action

You can't use a Bonus Action as an action, or the reverse. You get only one Bonus Action per turn.

Paired cantrip

A Bonus Action spell and a one-action cantrip are possible on the same turn, because the cantrip uses no slot.

Divine Smite and weapon features

Fighting styles and feats that adjust weapon damage dice don't apply to Divine Smite's dice, which are spell dice.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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